

FOLDER MANIPULATOR IN VB 6.0

■ ANANDARUP MUKHERJEE

The role of privacy is important in today's age. Be it personal files, photos or other documents, people tend to restrict the availability of their personal information from prying eyes. Modern software industry churns out many software that guarantee the much needed privacy. But at what cost? What is the guarantee that the unseen third parties will protect your privacy? How can you be so sure that they are not tinkering with your personal information without your knowledge? This can be answered by 'Open Source' software. Its code can be seen to judge whether the software is trustworthy or not. Easy said than done, here arises another problem; you need to have the technical knowledge to understand the code and its functionality.

The program given here addresses

these problems. The code is small and simple and anyone with basic coding skills can use this software without spending anything to make a folder locker or hider, which will protect the personal files. This program will generate a folder in your active C drive. You can lock, unlock, hide or unhide your personal information in a Windows XP operating system folder.

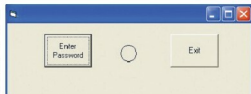
Software

The program code is divided into two parts—batch files and Visual Basic code.

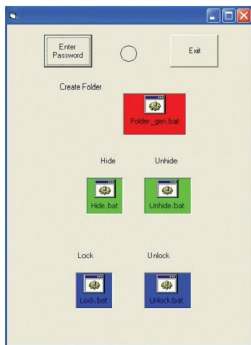
Batch files. Batch files are a series of commands that are interpreted and executed by the system interpreter (cmd.exe). Here, we will be using five different batch files—folder_gen, lock, unlock, hide and unhide.

Each of these files can be written in any Windows text editor (e.g., Notepad) and saved as *.bat. Double-clicking any of these files will execute the commands and perform a particular function as explained in the program operation section.

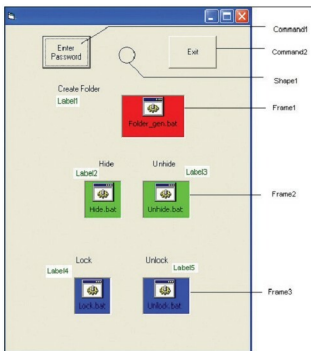
Visual Basic code. The main code for the GUI is done in Visual Basic (VB). Security password 'xyz123' is set in this VB code. The batch files are also embed-



Screenshot 2: Main program output window



Screenshot 3: Program output after entering correct password



Screenshot 1: Different frames and labels

ded in this code. The VB coding process is as given below:

1. Install Microsoft Visual Basic 6 in your system
2. Open 'Standard EXE' in VB 6
3. Rename 'Form1.caption' or make it blank
4. Insert three frames, make each caption field blank and set visibility property to 'false' as follows:

```
Frame1.visible= false
```

```
Frame2.visible= false
```

```
Frame3.visible= false
```

5. Insert Labels and OLE object frames as can be seen in Screenshot 1.